

The Console

A personal music interface built for listeners, not algorithms.

Concept summary · May 2026



PHIL 9000 — working proof of concept

The Problem

Streaming services have turned music listening into a marketing surface. Every session opens with promoted content, algorithmic recommendations, and imagery engineered to extend time-on-platform — not to help you listen to music. The music itself has become secondary to the platform's agenda.

A growing segment of listeners — particularly those who remember owning their music — want something different. They want to sit down, put something on, and just listen. No distractions. No marketing. Full control.

The Idea

The Console is a fully customizable music listening interface that connects to the audio sources a user already has — their personal library, public radio streams, and major streaming services — and presents them in a single, distraction-free environment. Think of it as a high-end remote control with an aesthetic you design yourself.

“Just a way to listen to your records. No garbage. Fully yours.”

The Console does not host, store, or stream any audio content. It is purely an interface layer, which keeps the legal and operational footprint minimal. Point it at what you already have. Make it look exactly how you want.

How It Works

Two open-source backend dependencies, both user-managed:

- **Navidrome** — self-hosted music library and playback server (Subsonic API)
- **AzuraCast** — self-hosted internet radio platform

The user configures two URLs, selects a theme, and the experience is live. No new infrastructure. No data migration. Streaming service widgets (Spotify, Apple Music, Tidal) are optionally embedded inside the console, stripped of their native marketing surfaces.

Product Tiers

Tier	Price	What You Get
Free	\$0	Curated public radio streams, basic player UI, 2 themes
Pro	Subscription	Personal library, all themes, full customization, streaming widgets, zero ads or promoted content

Target Audience

The primary user is not a technologist. They are someone who:

- Remembers what it felt like to put a record on and just listen
- Is frustrated by the cost, ads, and algorithmic noise of streaming services
- Wants ownership and control over their listening experience
- Is not willing — or able — to configure server infrastructure themselves

Secondary audience: self-hosters and audio enthusiasts who already run Navidrome or similar tools and want a premium interface. Communities like [r/selfhosted](#) and [r/musichoarder](#) are vocal, technically capable, and an ideal early-adopter base for validation.

Why Now

Spotify recently crossed 250 million paid subscribers — yet user sentiment has soured. Price increases, podcast pivots, and aggressive algorithmic promotion have alienated a meaningful share of long-term users. Apple Music, Amazon, and Tidal face similar criticisms.

Meanwhile, self-hosted audio tools have matured significantly. Navidrome and AzuraCast are stable, well-documented, and free. The infrastructure problem is largely solved. The missing piece is an interface polished enough to feel premium rather than hobbyist.

Copyright & Legal Position

The Console does not host, transmit, or distribute audio of any kind. It is a display and control layer only. Public radio streams are publicly licensed. Personal libraries are owned by the user. Streaming integrations use each platform's official embed or API. This positions The Console as a media player application — not a streaming service — with a correspondingly clean legal profile.

Immediate Next Step

Before any development begins, validate demand with a single post in [r/selfhosted](#) or [r/musichoarder](#). Share the PHIL 9000 screenshot with one question: “Would you use this?” The response will determine whether and how to proceed.

This is a passion project, not a funded venture. The goal at this stage is simply to find out if anyone else wants it.